

50 Proven Short-Form Video Hooks

Fill-in-the-Blank Templates + Real Examples from @taruns_ai

Every viral short-form video starts with a hook that stops the scroll in the first 2 seconds. Below are 50 battle-tested templates organized into 5 categories. Each hook includes a blank template you can adapt and a filled-in example using real results.

How to use this guide: Pick 1-2 hooks per video. Fill in the blanks with your own data. The more specific your numbers, the stronger the hook. Record the first line looking directly into the camera before anything else.

CATEGORY 1: ORIGIN STORY HOOKS (1-10)

These build relatability and trust. Use them to share your journey and make the audience see themselves in your story.

#	Template	Example
1	"I went from [old job/situation] to [new result] in [timeframe] . Here's what changed."	"I went from <i>burning cash on job boards</i> to <i>filling roles in 1 week instead of 6 in 3 months</i> . Here's what changed."
2	"Everyone told me [common fear] . They were wrong."	"Everyone told me <i>AI would never work for staffing recruitment</i> . They were wrong."
3	" [Time ago] I was [relatable situation] . Today I [impressive result] ."	" <i>Two years ago</i> I was <i>sending cold emails manually for \$15/hr</i> . Today I <i>build automations that generate 14,000 leads on autopilot</i> ."
4	"I almost quit [industry/skill] because of [specific frustration] . Then I discovered [solution] ."	"I almost quit <i>freelancing</i> because of <i>inconsistent income</i> . Then I discovered <i>automation-as-a-service retainers</i> ."
5	"The moment I realized [old approach] was broken, everything changed."	"The moment I realized <i>manual lead follow-up was losing 60% of prospects</i> , everything changed."
6	"Here's the truth about [your field] nobody told me when I started."	"Here's the truth about <i>AI automation consulting</i> nobody told me when I started."
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	"I built my first [deliverable] in [short time] . It replaced [what the client was doing] ."	"I built my first <i>60-node n8n workflow</i> in <i>one weekend</i> . It replaced <i>3 full-time employees doing manual data entry</i> ."
8	"My biggest failure in [field] taught me the one thing courses never will."	"My biggest failure in <i>client onboarding</i> taught me the one thing courses never will."
9	"I charged [\$[low amount]] for my first [service] . Now I charge [\$[high amount]] . Here's what changed."	"I charged <i>\$200</i> for my first <i>automation build</i> . Now I charge <i>\$14,840 per project</i> . Here's what changed."
10	" [Number] months ago I had zero clients. Today I'm [credential/result] ."	" <i>18</i> months ago I had zero clients. Today I'm <i>Top Rated Plus on Upwork with 100% Job Success</i> ."

CATEGORY 2: TEACHING HOOKS (11-20)

Position yourself as the expert. These hooks promise a specific lesson and create a knowledge gap the viewer needs to close.

#	Template	Example
11	"Stop doing [common mistake] . Do this instead."	"Stop doing <i>manual data entry for your CRM</i> . Do this instead."
12	"One thing changed how I [skill/outcome] . It's not what you think."	"One thing changed how I <i>close freelance clients</i> . It's not what you think."
13	"Most people [wrong approach] . Here's the right way."	"Most people <i>build automations without mapping the workflow first</i> . Here's the right way."
14	"The [number] -step system I use to [desirable outcome] every single time."	"The <i>4</i> -step system I use to <i>hit 93-98% email open rates</i> every single time."
15	"If you're still [outdated method] , you're leaving [money/time] on the table."	"If you're still <i>manually following up with leads</i> , you're leaving <i>\$10K+ per month</i> on the table."
16	" [Tool/platform] has a feature 95% of users don't know about. It does [result] ."	" <i>n8n</i> has a feature 95% of users don't know about. It does <i>full API reverse engineering with HTTP nodes</i> ."
17	"I'm going to show you how to [outcome] in [short time] . No [common requirement] needed."	"I'm going to show you how to <i>build a lead gen machine</i> in <i>one afternoon</i> . No coding needed."

18	"Here's the exact [system/template/prompt] I use for [task] . Steal it."	"Here's the exact <i>content repurposing workflow</i> I use for <i>turning one voice memo into 42 posts per month</i> . Steal it."
19	" [Beginner mistake] is why your [effort] isn't working. Fix it in [time] ."	" <i>Not segmenting your lead list</i> is why your <i>email outreach</i> isn't working. Fix it in <i>10 minutes</i> ."
20	"The [tool] stack I'd use if I had to start over from zero today."	"The <i>AI automation</i> stack I'd use if I had to start over from zero today."

CATEGORY 3: CONTRARIAN HOOKS (21-30)

These challenge conventional wisdom. They trigger curiosity and a need to find out why you disagree with the crowd.

#	Template	Example
21	"Everyone says [common advice] . That's wrong. Here's why."	"Everyone says <i>you need to learn to code before you automate</i> . That's wrong. Here's why."
22	" [Popular thing] is overrated. Here's what actually works."	" <i>Zapier</i> is overrated. Here's what actually works."
23	"The [industry] secret nobody talks about."	"The <i>staffing automation</i> secret nobody talks about."
24	" [Common strategy] is dead. I've tested it. Here's the data."	" <i>Cold email without personalization</i> is dead. I've tested it. Here's the data."
25	"Unpopular opinion: [bold claim] . And I have the receipts."	"Unpopular opinion: <i>you don't need more leads, you need better follow-up</i> . And I have the receipts."
26	" [Guru advice] is terrible advice for [specific group] . Here's what to do instead."	" <i>'Niche down to one service'</i> is terrible advice for <i>new automation freelancers</i> . Here's what to do instead."
27	"I stopped [common practice] and my [metric] went up [percentage] ."	"I stopped <i>pitching hourly rates</i> and my <i>average project value</i> went up <i>400%</i> ."
28	" [Number] % of [professionals] are doing [task] wrong. Are you one of them?"	" <i>90%</i> of <i>freelancers</i> are doing <i>client onboarding</i> wrong. Are you one of them?"

29	"The worst advice I ever followed was '[bad advice].' Here's what I do now."	"The worst advice I ever followed was <i>'take any client who can pay.'</i> Here's what I do now."
30	" [Trendy approach] won't save your business. [Boring approach] will."	" <i>Chasing viral TikToks</i> won't save your business. <i>Building a 60-node automated pipeline</i> will."

CATEGORY 4: RESULTS / PROOF HOOKS (31-40)

Nothing stops the scroll like real numbers. Use these to flex specific, verifiable outcomes.

#	Template	Example
31	"I turned [small input] into [big output] . Here's how."	"I turned a <i>20-minute voice memo</i> into <i>42 pieces of content per month at 95% brand voice accuracy</i> . Here's how."
32	" [Client type] was spending [time/money] on [task] . I cut it to [result] ."	"A <i>staffing firm</i> was spending <i>6 weeks</i> on <i>hiring per role</i> . I cut it to <i>1 week</i> ."
33	" [Metric] went from [before] to [after] . One change."	" <i>Qualified candidate rate</i> went from <i>40%</i> to <i>78%</i> . One change."
34	"This [deliverable] generated [result] in the first [timeframe] ."	"This <i>automated lead gen workflow</i> generated <i>14,000 leads</i> in the first <i>quarter</i> ."
35	"My client went from [problem state] to [success state] in [time] . I'll show you the system."	"My client went from <i>burning \$20K/month on ads</i> to <i>spending 30% of that for the same clients</i> in <i>60 days</i> . I'll show you the system."
36	" [Number] clients. [Number] results. [Number] failures. Here's what I learned."	" <i>15 staffing firms. 15 results. Zero failures.</i> Here's what I learned."
37	"I saved my client [hours/dollars] per [time period] with one automation."	"I saved my client <i>120 hours per month</i> with one automation."
38	"Before and after: what [process] looks like with AI automation."	"Before and after: what <i>healthcare lead generation</i> looks like with AI automation."
39	" [Impressive stat] . That's not a typo. Let me explain."	" <i>93-98% email open rates</i> . That's not a typo. Let me explain."

40	"Here's a [deliverable] that pays for itself in [short timeframe] ."	"Here's a <i>\$5K automation build</i> that pays for itself in <i>two weeks</i> ."
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CATEGORY 5: QUESTION HOOKS (41-50)

Questions force the brain to answer. They create an open loop that keeps the viewer watching for the resolution.

#	Template	Example
41	"What if you could [desirable outcome] in [short time] ?"	"What if you could <i>fill every open role</i> in <i>one week instead of six</i> ?"
42	"How many hours did you spend on [task] last week? Be honest."	"How many hours did you spend on <i>manually entering leads into your CRM</i> last week? Be honest."
43	"Would you pay [\$small amount] to save [\$large amount] ?"	"Would you pay <i>\$5,000</i> to save <i>\$14,000 per month in ad spend</i> ?"
44	"What's stopping you from [goal] ? I bet it's [common blocker] ."	"What's stopping you from <i>scaling past \$10K/month</i> ? I bet it's <i>doing everything manually</i> ."
45	"Do you know how much [inefficiency] is actually costing your business?"	"Do you know how much <i>slow candidate follow-up</i> is actually costing your staffing firm?"
46	"Why are [successful group] switching to [your solution] ?"	"Why are <i>top staffing agencies</i> switching to <i>AI-powered candidate screening</i> ?"
47	"What would you do with [freed-up resource] if [task] was fully automated?"	"What would you do with <i>30 extra hours per week</i> if <i>lead generation and follow-up</i> was fully automated?"
48	"Can you guess how many [items] one [system] can [action] per [time] ?"	"Can you guess how many <i>qualified leads</i> one <i>n8n workflow</i> can <i>generate</i> per month? Try 14,000."
49	"Is [your industry] about to be disrupted by [technology/trend] ? (Spoiler: yes.)"	"Is <i>staffing and recruitment</i> about to be disrupted by <i>AI automation</i> ? (Spoiler: yes.)"
50	"What if I told you [surprising claim] — and I could prove it?"	

"What if I told you a *single automation workflow replaced 3 full-time employees* — and I could prove it?"

HOW TO USE THESE HOOKS

1. **Pick your category** based on the video's goal: build trust (Origin), educate (Teaching), stand out (Contrarian), convert (Results), or engage (Question).
2. **Fill in the blanks** with YOUR specific data. Vague hooks die. Specific numbers stop the scroll.
3. **Deliver the hook in the first 1.5 seconds.** Look into the camera. No intro, no "Hey guys." Just the hook.
4. **Rotate categories** so your feed doesn't feel repetitive. Aim for at least 3 different categories per week.
5. **Save your best performers** and create variations. A hook that works once will work again with different details.

Pro tip: The hooks with real numbers (Category 4) consistently outperform all others. Always lead with your best metric: 93-98% open rates, 6 weeks to 1 week, 14K leads, 40% to 78% qualified rate. Numbers are scroll-stoppers.